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Find mental health resources for immigrants and refugees

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Many people experience mental health problems. In the USA, it is common to seek help for these issues. It is nothing to be embarrassed about. Learn about the different types of treatment and mental health resources for immigrants.

What is mental health?

Mental health is about your feelings, how you think, and how you act. It is an important part of your overall health. It can even affect your physical health. Good mental health helps you deal with daily life, make good choices, and handle stress.

Many things can affect your mental health. As an immigrant, you might face different challenges that can affect how you feel. Adjusting to life in the USA can feel

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When to consider getting help

Mental health is just as important as your physical health. Getting treatment can help you feel better and improve the quality of your life.

It may be time to seek support if:

- You often feel sad or anxious
- You are unable to cope with daily tasks
- You experience changes in sleeping or eating patterns

There is help out there for you. It can be hard for some people to talk about their feelings, especially if it is not something you did in your home country. It is okay to need help and not something to be ashamed of.

Types of treatment

The two most common types of mental health treatment are:

- **Therapy** includes psychotherapy or 'talk therapy' but there are many different types. You can speak to a therapist by yourself or in a group.

Who can offer treatment?

Different professionals are trained to treat mental illnesses in the United States:

- **Primary care providers** are licensed to treat general health problems and can prescribe medication.
- **Psychiatrists** are medical doctors licensed to check for mental health problems, provide therapy, and prescribe medications.
- **Psychologists** are professionals licensed to test mental health problems and give therapy. Psychologists cannot prescribe medications.
- **Social workers** are licensed to assess and treat mental health problems.
- **Counselors and therapists** are licensed to provide therapy.
- **Peer specialists** are professionals who have experienced mental health conditions and are trained to offer emotional support.

Mental health professionals may work with specific groups, such as refugees or children. They may also be trained in specific areas and may focus on depression, addiction, or trauma. Many offer services that are culturally sensitive and some can provide support in languages other than English.

How to find mental health services

It can take time to find the right mental health help but you have options. You can find help through your:

- Primary care doctor. They can check your mental health and refer you to specialists. Your health insurance may cover help.
- **Friends and family**. They might know good resources or professionals.
- **Local resettlement agencies** if you get ORR benefits as a refugee, asylee, or other eligible immigrant. They offer special support for immigrants.
- **Community and religious organizations**. These places often have mental health resources.
- **School or college**. They often provide student mental health services.
- **Workplace programs**. Check if your employer offers an Employee Assistance Program (EAP).
- **Public library**. Use them for information and local service recommendations.

You can also search for services and providers online:

Asian Mental Health Collective	List of services for Asian communities
Center for Victims of Torture	Mental health services and support for survivors of war and torture in Arizona, Georgia, and Minnesota
Coalition for Immigrant Health	List of mental health services in Illinois for immigrant communities
HRSA Health Center Locator	List of centers providing general health and mental health services
Immigrants Rising	Helps undocumented youth find mental health support
Inclusive Therapists	List of culturally responsive counseling services
InReach	List of mental health and other resources for LGBTQ+ immigrants
Institute for Muslim Mental Health	Resources for Muslim Americans
Latinx Therapy	List of counseling services for the Latinx community in the U.S.

National Alliance on Mental Health	List of mental health resources
Psychology Today	List of therapists by zip code
SAMHSA Services Locator	List of clinics that treat mental health problems or substance abuse
SAMHSA Substance Abuse Locator	List of facilities that treat substance abuse and addiction
South Asian Therapists	List of counseling services for the South Asian community in the U.S.
United We Dream	List of free or low-cost services for undocumented immigrants
USCRI Wellness Helpline	Counseling for new refugees and immigrants

Immediate help

It may take some time for you to get an appointment with a mental health provider. Here are ways to find support and care for yourself in the meantime.

down. Try the 4-7-8 method. Breathe in for 4 seconds, hold your breath for 7 seconds, and exhale for 8 seconds.

- **Do an activity you enjoy.** Do something that will make you feel better, such as going for a walk, journaling, or listening to music.
- **Be healthy.** Eat balanced meals, stay hydrated, avoid alcohol, and aim for 7-9 hours of sleep each night to support your mood and energy levels.
- **Call or text a crisis hotline**.
- **Join a support group**.

Crisis hotlines

Crisis hotlines offer free support for people experiencing an emotional crisis. They keep your information confidential and do not share it with anyone. They are usually available at all hours of the day and every day of the week. All of these hotlines are staffed by counselors trained to listen and provide help. Some offer support in multiple languages.

Contact	Number
988 Suicide Prevention and Crisis Lifeline	988 *(call or text)*

Disaster Distress Helpline	800-985-5990 *(call or text)*
National Child Abuse Hotline	800-422-4453 *(call or text)*
National Domestic Violence Hotline	800-799-7233 88788 *(text START)*
National Human Trafficking Hotline	888-373-7888 *(call)* 233733 *(text)*
National Runaway Safeline	800-786-2929 *(call or text)*
National Sexual Assault Hotline	800-656-4673 *(call)*
Teen Line	800-852-8336 *(call)* 839863 *(text)*
Trevor Project for LGBTQ+ youth	866-488-7386 *(call)* 678678 *(text)*
Veterans Crisis Line	988 (*call and press 1*) 838255 *(text)*

Most of these lines also have an option to chat online. Visit their website to check. If you are texting any of these lines, texting “hello” should connect you to someone.

Peer support groups

Peer support groups are with people who have had similar experiences. In these groups, people get the chance to share their experiences and get support from people in their community.

- Immigrants Rising Wellness Support Groups are for undocumented groups, including Black, LGBTQ+, and Latinx individuals.
- NAMI Connection Support Groups are free and for anyone with a mental health condition.
- NAMI Family Support Groups are free and for family members who have loved ones with mental health conditions.

Mental health toolkits

- Immigrants Rising Mental Health Toolkit
- United We Dream Community Care Toolkit

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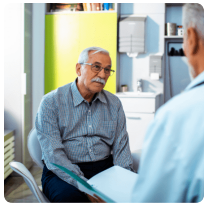
Understanding mental health: a guide for immigrants

Mental health is important. Learn about mental health conditions and their signs. Find information for immigrants. Understanding mental health can make sure you and your loved ones get the help you need.

How to go to the doctor



It is important to go to the doctor for medical help. Learn how to find a doctor near you and how to schedule an appointment. Get information on what to do in the case of an emergency. Know your rights.

What to do if someone is threatening you

It can be scary and stressful when someone is threatening you. It is important to know how to respond to threats and protect yourself. Learn about the steps you can take, how to report threats, and get help.

Understanding depression for immigrants and refugees

Immigrant and refugee trauma

Many immigrants and refugees experience trauma. Learn about the signs of trauma and post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD). Find tips for dealing with trauma and how to find treatment.

Culture shock and cultural adjustment

Moving to a new country can be challenging. It is completely normal for immigrants to feel “culture shock.” You may feel anxious and stressed as you get used to a new place and culture. Learn about culture adjustment and how to find support in your new community.

The information on this page comes from mentalhealth.gov, NAMI, SAMHSA, and other trusted sources. We aim to offer easy to understand information that is updated regularly. This information is not legal advice.

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